



Digital inhaler

The FDA has approved the ProAir Digihaler, an app-connected digital inhaler which houses built-in sensors. <https://digit.in/jan19-39>



ThinkPad earbuds

Lenovo has released a ThinkPad-inspired pair of bluetooth earbuds called the 'Thinkplus Pods One' in China. <https://digit.in/jan19-40>

Huawei Mate 20 Pro 128GB

More than just a camera smartphone

When the Huawei Mate 20 Pro came to our labs there were some things that were immediately apparent; this is an over-engineered smartphone and that is a great thing. However, is all that glitter really gold?

Build and Design

The front has a curved display just like Samsung's flagship design with extremely narrow edges. The camera unit is a black square housing three lenses and a flash unit have the four entities arranged in a 2x2 grid, i.e Huawei's Matrix design.

The Huawei Mate 20 Pro also carries an IP68 rating, and is protected by an unspecified version of Corning Gorilla Glass on the front. There are no speaker grilles visible because the speaker is built into the charging port. When the phone is plugged in for charging, the sound does change.

Display

The 6.39 inch 2K display is absolutely fantastic in almost every regard. The colours and contrast pop on the Mate 20's display. In our display luminosity test, the Mate 20 Pro clocked 730 lux of maximum brightness and a minimum of two, which makes it truly versatile.

On the Mate 20 Pro though, the notch houses the array of sensors to enable face unlock. Huawei's implementation of using a depth sensor is a genuine alternative to Face ID. Similarly, the in-display fingerprint sensor works reliably and fast. However, while trying to register the fingerprint, the phone keeps saying "please clean finger" after every scan.

Performance and UI

The boot-times of the smartphone are impressive. The Kirin 980 shoots just



Price
₹69,990



FEATURE.....	90
PERFORMANCE.....	84
VALUE.....	81
DESIGN.....	89

barely past the OnePlus 6, but is significantly behind 2018's iPhones. In day-to-day usage, the hardware does not disappoint in the least. Probably the most impressive has been the ability to edit the massive 40-megapixel RAW files in Adobe Lightroom Mobile easily.

Running on Android 9 based EMUI 9, there are a few nagging issues. The animations are not smooth. Also, the Dark UI theme is placed under battery options, not very user-intuitive, which can be said for the overall menu organisation as well.

Camera

In terms of performance, the camera is pretty fast to focus and shoot across all three lenses. When shooting in pro mode in RAW, there is a slight lag across all three lenses. The images resulting from all three lenses exhibit

great colours and good sharpness. The ultra-wide angle lens especially has very well controlled distortion and with the addition of autofocus, it enables plenty of creative avenues. The 80mm f/2.4 lens continues to be a Huawei exclusive and is actually a boon to have for portraits.

Huawei offers a 24-megapixel front-facing shooter and it happens to do a decent job of taking selfies. The images could use a little more local contrast for sharpness. Selfies do suffer in low light though, with images developing noise fairly quickly.

Battery life

The 4200mAh on the Mate 20 Pro really does not disappoint. On the PCMark 8 battery test, the Mate 20 Pro lasts close to 10 hours, losing to the Galaxy Note 9 just an hour. Honestly, the battery didn't matter much given the proprietary SuperCharge feature, which tops up the battery to 70 per cent within just 30 minutes. Given that the Huawei Mate 20 Pro has a 4200mAh battery, that means roughly 3000mAh of juice, enough to get through the day.

Verdict

The Huawei Mate 20 Pro is the most impressive Android phone to come out in 2018. The main highlight of the Mate 20 Pro continues to be its excellent imaging stack. Overall, if you do buy the Mate 20 Pro, you're going to find yourself extremely happy with the phone's performance and output.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Hisilicon Kirin 980 | GPU: Mali-G76 MP10 | OS: Android 9.0 | CARD SLOT: NM, up to 256 GB | SIZE: 6.39-inches | RESOLUTION: 1440 x 3120 pixels | CAMERA PRIMARY: Triple 40 MP wide (f/1.8, 27mm, 1/1.7", PDAF) + 20 MP ultrawide (f/2.2, 16mm) + 8 MP (f/2.4, 80mm) | CAMERA SECONDARY: 24 MP (f/2.0).

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